

C. Luke Watson

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Research Interests

Public Economics, Urban Economics, Industrial Organization
Tax Incidence, Bank Branching and Competition, Housing Demand

Employment

Senior Financial Economist, Center for Financial Research, FDIC	Aug 2023
Financial Economist, Center for Financial Research, FDIC	Aug 2021 - Aug 2023

Education

Ph.D. Economics, Michigan State University	2015 - 2021
M.A. Economics, Old Dominion University	2013 - 2015
B.A. Economics, Old Dominion University	2009 - 2013

Publications

“Is the Rent Too High: Land Ownership and Monopoly Power” (with O.Ziv)	2026
– Accepted, Real Estate Economics	
“A Test for Pricing Power in Urban Housing Markets” (with O.Ziv)	2025
– Accepted, Review of Economics and Statistics	

Working Papers

“When Does Market Definition Matter for Identification?”	2026
“Bank Competition for Neighborhood Deposits” (with M.Kutzbach, G.Wagner)	2026

Selected Works in Progress

“Measuring Local Liquid Savings” (with M.Kutzbach, G.Wagner)
“A Test for Collusion in Housing Markets Using Algorithmic Pricing”
(with A.Handler, C.Spaenjers, & O.Ziv)
“Estimating Markups using Pass-Through Regressions” (with O.Ziv)

Prior Employment

Instructor : Development Economics (Michigan State University)	Fall 2020
Instructor : Principles of Microeconomics (Old Dominion University)	Summer 2015
TA : (MSU) Public Revenues, Ec. of Poverty & Income, Int’l Trade (x4), Urban Econ (x3)	
Interm.Micro, Intro.Micro, Intro.Macro	2015-2020
TA : (AEASP) Foundations Microeconomics and Mathematics	Summer 2017
RA : (MSU) Oren Ziv, Prabhat Barnwal, (ODU) Gary Wagner, Tim Komarek	2013-2020
Barista : Starbucks	2009-2015

Presentations

2026: Society of Government Economists, FDIC Consumer Finance Round Robin.
 2025: Richmond Fed, AREUEA Nat'l, NYC DOF, DC Urban Day.
 2024: Lincoln Institute UE & PE Conference. 2023: Mid-Atlantic Trade Workshop, NTA.
 2022: AREUEA / ASSA, AREUEA Nat'l, NTA, UEA (USA). 2021: UEA (Europe).
 2020: Ohio University, MVEA, NTA. 2019: NTA.

FDIC Projects

Memo: DI Limits Increases [Internal]	2025
Deposit Study: GFC Runs [Internal, In-progress]	2025
Deposit Study: Deposit Stability [Internal, In-progress]	2025
Options for Deposit Insurance Reform [Public]	2023
Literature Review on Digital Currencies and Financial Stability [Internal]	2022
Crypto-Watch Paper Round-Up [Internal]	2022-2025

Dissertation Work on EITC

"The General Equilibrium Incidence of the Earned Income Tax Credit"	2021
"Estimating Supply & Demand Elasticities Using a Single Tax Rate with GE Spillovers"	2021
"The Local Labor Market Effects of State EITC Supplements"	2021

Service

AEASP-FDIC - Experiential Learning Partner	Summer 2024
FDIC - History of the FDIC presenter	2024-2025
FDIC - CFR Seminar Coordinator	2022-2024
FDIC - Reader for FDIC Consumer Research Symposium	2022-2023
Michigan State University - Applied Economics Student Workshop Organizer	2017-2020
Michigan State University - Graduate Student Seminar Organizer	2018-2020
Michigan State University - Graduate Instruction Committee	2017-2018
Old Dominion University - Ad Hoc Committee on Birthday Singing	2013-2015

Referee Service

Contemporary Economic Policy, International Tax and Public Finance, Journal of Financial Services Research, Journal of Real Estate Finance and Economics, Journal of Urban Economics, Public Finance Review

Awards and Grants

Mission Achievement Award (FDIC)	2023,2025
Star Award (FDIC)	2024,2025
Dissertation Completion Fellowship (MSU)	2020
Outstanding Graduate Economics Student Award (ODU)	2015
Graduate Student Tuition Fellowship (ODU)	2013-2015
Constant Dominion Business Student Merit Scholarship (ODU)	2013
Town-N-Gown Scholarship (ODU)	2013
Governor's Technology Tuition Scholarship (ODU)	2009-2013
Time Magazine Person of the Year (shared)	2006

Memberships

American Economics Association, American Real Estate and Urban Economics Association, National Tax Association